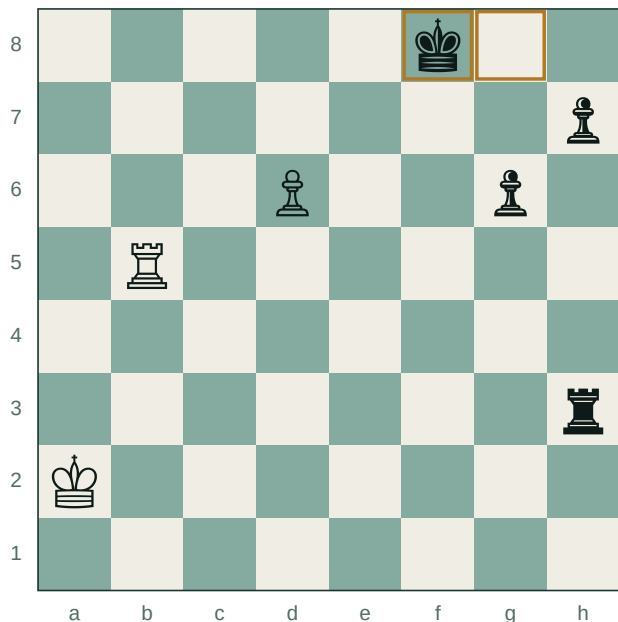


# Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 44

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 43...Kf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**44. Rb8+ Kf7 45. d7**

**44.Rb8+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **44...Kf7**.

**45.d7** The pawn moves from d6 to d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h3. Check for tactical protection.